



ReGen Civics Quest Field Guide

Deep Nourishment

regencivics.earth

What This Quest Is

Forage mushrooms, medicinal herbs, berries, and tree magic. Learn to read the land around you, harvest with reciprocity, and nourish your body with food that grew in real soil, in real weather, in your own bioregion.

Story Card

For most of human history, people knew the land around them intimately. They knew which plants healed and which harmed, which fungi fruited after rain. That knowledge lived in people, passed through hands and seasons and walking together. In a generation or two, most of it was lost. Wild foods carry things that cultivated foods do not: biodiversity in the microbiome they arrive with, compounds that plants produce in real ecological competition. Beyond the nutrition, foraging changes your relationship to a place. When you learn what grows where, the land is no longer scenery. It is a conversation.

How To Do This Quest

Step 1: Learn your bioregion's wild edible landscape.

Start with 5-10 plants or fungi you can identify with certainty. Use local field guides. Join a local foraging walk. Certainty matters — do not eat anything you cannot identify with confidence.

Step 2: Go out at least three times over at least two weeks.

Foraging as a single experience gives you little. Going out across different weather and terrain begins to give you a sense of patterns.

Step 3: Harvest with intention.

Take no more than a third of any plant in a given area. Leave the rest to seed, recover, and feed others. Where possible, give something back.

Step 4: Prepare and eat what you have found.

Cook or use your harvest. Note the difference in taste, texture, and how your body responds compared to store-bought equivalents.

Step 5: Document your finds.

Photos of each species in situ. Notes on where, when, condition, what you did with it. Build a personal field record.

Step 6: Share your harvest and knowledge.

Cook for others using what you found. Share your field record. Teach someone one thing you learned.

Deliverable

A field record (photos + notes) of your foraging sessions and a reflection on what changed in your relationship to the land.

Tips

- Three non-negotiables: local field guide, local expertise, and the rule that you eat only what you can identify with full certainty.
- Start with the most distinctive plants: blackberries, elderberries, nettles, dandelions are good starting points in most temperate regions.
- Fall is best for fungi in most temperate climates. Spring is best for many greens.

Resources

- A local field guide for your bioregion (not generic worldwide guides)
- iNaturalist app (species identification and community verification)
- Search for a local foraging community, club, or walk in your city

A Place to Write

Species found, locations, what you did with them:
